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SATURDAY, JULY 19, 2025

US memo says Öztürk has no tie to antisemitism

Also indicates she didn't back terrorist groups

By Giulia McDonnell Nieto del Rio
GLOBE STAFF

The Department of Homeland Security found no evidence that Tufts PhD student Rümeyza Öztürk engaged in antisemitic activity or made public statements that showed support for a terrorist organization, according to a State Department memo discussed in federal court in Boston Friday.

The contents of the memo came out during the last day of witness testimony in a lawsuit brought by higher education organizations, including the American Association of University Professors, over the Trump administration's policies of arresting and detaining international students and others engaged in pro-Palestinian activism.

Öztürk, originally from Turkey, was arrested in late March, and authorities are seeking her deportation; her attorneys argue she was targeted solely for an op-ed she co-wrote in the Tufts student newspaper in support of Palestinians.

John Armstrong, a top official in the State Department's Bureau of Consular Affairs, testified Friday that he made the decision to revoke Öztürk's visa.

But during her questioning of Armstrong, Alexandra Conlon, an attorney for the plaintiffs in the case, cited excerpts from a State Department "action memo" about Öztürk and its

TRIAL, Page A6



AP/GETTY/
ADOBE/GLOBE STAFF

Blue states face puzzle on vouchers

School payment plan has strong allies — and foes

By Christopher Huffaker
GLOBE STAFF

Many students across New England could soon receive federal voucher-like funds to attend private school under a plan laid out in President Trump's recently approved tax and spending bill.

The plan, which essentially creates the first national voucher system, could bring an increasingly popular form of school choice to a region that has thus far mostly resisted using vouchers. State leaders will now get to decide whether to sign on to the program, with details to be worked out in federal rule making.

The new system, which will begin in 2027, allows all but the wealthiest families to access private school scholarships funded by voluntary tax credits — but only in states that opt in. Residents in any state, however, will be able to claim a full tax credit for donating up to \$1,700 to an authorized scholarship fund, which would then hand out funds to students. (Taxpayers would have to owe at least \$1,700 on their annual return to receive the credit.)

Teachers unions and other progressive groups oppose the plan because it would divert students, and therefore money, from public schools, increasing the budgetary pressure on traditional public schools already facing the financial consequences of declining enrollments.

VOUCHERS, Page A7

Mayor presses for answers

‘It’s very important in a crisis that people stay in contact.’

FALL RIVER MAYOR PAUL COOGAN, *expressing frustration at trying to connect with Gabriel House owner Dennis Etzkorn*



PHOTOS BY SUZANNE KREITER/GLOBE STAFF

Mobility devices used by people who lived at Gabriel House were loaded onto a truck Friday to be returned to them.

DA mistakenly reported 10th person had died in blaze

By Nick Stoico
GLOBE STAFF
and Ava Berger
and Angela Mathew
GLOBE CORRESPONDENTS

FALL RIVER — In the days since a devastating fire broke out in an assisted living facility here, killing nine people and injuring dozens, Mayor Paul Coogan said Friday the owner of Gabriel House has failed to maintain regular contact with city officials or reach out to relatives of residents who perished in the blaze.

Meanwhile in an extraordinary admission, Bristol District Attorney Thomas M. Quinn III's office acknowledged it had mistakenly announced on Thursday, that a 10th resident had died. She



Police tape and boarded-up windows told the story at Gabriel House on Friday.

remains in critical condition in a Rhode Island hospital with severe burns.

In a wide-ranging interview from his office Friday, the Fall

►The state wants information on emergency response plans for assisted living homes. B1.

River mayor expressed continued frustration with Gabriel House owner Dennis Etzkorn, whose cooperation he said is necessary to help residents in the aftermath of the blaze.

“It’s very important in a crisis that people stay in contact,” Coogan said

Coogan he first met with Etzkorn at his City Hall office only on Wednesday, and that their communication has been intermittent

FIRE, Page A6

The number of single-family home sales in June jumped up **19.6%** from last month, and 5.8 percent year-over-year, with 1,292 sold.

‘The brutal reality’: median home price hits \$1 million

Greater Boston figure may be unnerving but no surprise to agents

By Janelle Nanos
GLOBE STAFF

One. Million. Dollars. It's a phrase best pronounced in the voice of Austin Powers's nemesis Dr. Evil, and for the first time, it's also the price of the typical house sold in Greater Boston.

That's according to the Greater Boston Association of Realtors, which released June sales data covering most of the region Thursday, with the median price for a single-family house registering just above \$1 million. Tipping over into seven digits puts Greater Boston in some rarified air as a true “superstar city,” matching prices typically found only in New York City, the San Francisco Bay Area, and Southern California.

What that means for the housing market depends mainly on where you sit, and whether you own a house or aspire to.

“I’ll say it’s a sad thing that it has reached that spot,” said Melvin Vieira Jr., with RE/MAX Real Estate Center and past president of GBAR. “But it’s a good thing that it has reached that spot as well.”

The number of single-family home sales in June jumped up 19.6 percent from last month, and 5.8 percent year-over-year, with 1,292 sold, according to GBAR's numbers, which cover most of Greater Boston aside from the North and South shores. Condominium sales rose 1.8 percent year over year, with 986 sold in June.

The million-dollar figure came as little surprise to Dino Confalone of Gibson Sotheby's International Realty in Cambridge. The local real estate community has been anticipating it for months, he said, with the median single-family home price hovering just below that mark all spring.

And while unnerving for some, Confalone said, it does reflect well on the area.

“For decades, I’ve said Boston is un-

ONE MILLION, Page A10

On Nantucket, the new status symbol is an old car

By Beth Teitell
GLOBE STAFF

NANTUCKET — The hydrangeas were blooming, the ferries were packed, and the summer people, with their goldendoodles and Brazilian blowouts, had arrived. They were working on their backhands, sending their kids to surf school, and mock-complaining about all the billionaires on the island, but secretly they were glad for the reflected status. They were dressing casually but carefully for cocktail parties on deck after deck after deck, and exclaiming over the raw bars, commonplace though they've become, and all was glorious.

Well, almost.

Something was nagging, and here it was now, cruising around downtown Nantucket. It was a status symbol that you can't just go out and acquire, at least not instantly: a perfectly restored vintage four-wheel-drive vehicle.

In this case, it was a 1969 Bronco, in Brittany Blue, helmed by one Lee Milazzo, owner of the Samuel Owen galleries on Nantucket and in Greenwich, Conn. He's a man who is both an enthusiastic social critic and also de-

BRONCOS, Page A10



BEN PENNINGTON FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

Lee Milazzo, a gallery owner, drove his 1969 Brittany Blue Ford Bronco on Nantucket.

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Suggested retail price
\$4.00



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Fielder's choice

Saturday: Sunny, pleasant.
High: 82-87. Low: 69-74.

Sunday: Showers, stormy.
Comics and Weather, **D4-5.**

Obituaries, **C9.**

Ten Americans and US permanent residents who had been seized by Venezuelan authorities were freed in exchange for the release of more than 200 Venezuelan migrants whom the Trump administration sent to a prison in El Salvador. **A2.**

The FDA prepared to ask Sarepta to halt shipments of its gene therapy for Duchenne muscular dystrophy. **D1.**

A federal court was asked to release grand jury transcripts linked to Jeffrey Epstein. **A2.**